FORCES AND MOTION

GUIDED NOTES · PHASE 02 · 6 SECTIONS

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

UNIT LEARNING TARGETS

- I can state Newton's three laws and use Fg = mg to find an object's weight.
- I can draw a free-body diagram and find the net force on an object, including forces at an angle.
- I can split an object's weight into parts along and into a ramp and find the normal force.
- I can use ∑F = ma to find acceleration, including on a ramp and in an elevator.
- I can tell static from kinetic friction and find friction, net force and acceleration on level ground and on a ramp.
- I can find tension and acceleration for objects joined by cables, ropes and pulleys.

KEY TERMS

- **S03.1** Force, newton (N), mass, weight, equilibrium, net force
- **S03.2** Free-body diagram, normal force, tension, resultant, components
- **S03.3** Incline, Fg,parallel, Fg,perp
- **S03.4** Acceleration, apparent weight
- **S03.5** Static friction, kinetic friction, coefficient of friction (μ)
- **S03.6** Ideal string, pulley, Atwood machine

HOW THESE NOTES WORK

- The left column names the slide each block comes from.
- While that slide is up, write each idea in your own words on the lines under its prompt.
- In each work box, state your positive direction and carry units to the answer.

SECTIONS IN THIS UNIT

		DIFFICULTY
☐	S03.1 Newton's Laws	**3 / 10**
☐	S03.2 Free-Body Diagrams	**6 / 10**
☐	S03.3 Forces on an Incline	**5 / 10**
☐	S03.4 Net Force and Acceleration	**6 / 10**
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☐	S03.6 Connected Objects	**8 / 10**

Estimated difficulty: 1 = introductory; 10 = highly challenging.

EQUATION TOOLBOX

Newton's laws

$F_g = mg$

$\sum F = ma$

$a = \frac{\sum F}{m}$

$F_N - mg = ma$ (up is positive)

Components

$F_x = F\cos\theta$

$F_y = F\sin\theta$

$\sum F = \sqrt{(F_x^2 + F_y^2)}$

$\theta = \tan^{-1}(F_y/F_x)$

Ramps and friction

$F_{g,parallel} = mg\sin\theta$

$F_{g,perp} = mg\cos\theta$

$F_N = mg\cos\theta$ (ramp, no other perpendicular force)

$f_{s,max} = \mu_s F_N$

$f_k \approx \mu_k F_N$

∑F means net force (the slides write Fnet).
g = 9.8 m/s² on Earth. 1 N = 1 kg·m/s². μ has no units. Frictionless ramp: a = g sin θ.

Newton’s Laws

LEARNING TARGET I can state Newton’s three laws and use Fg = mg to find an object’s weight.

FORCE · MASS AND WEIGHT

Slides 3–4

Common mix-up: mass (kg) and weight (N) are different quantities.

Force: definition and unit

Mass vs. weight: meaning and units

Weight: equation, g on Earth, and the 10 kg example

WEIGHT ON EARTH AND THE MOON

Slide 5

Same mass, different gravity

Given: m = 60 kg; Earth: g = 9.8 m/s²; Moon: g = 1.6 m/s². **Find:** weight in each location.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

NEWTON'S THREE LAWS

Slides 6–8

Common mix-up: a moving object does not need a net force to keep moving. A moving puck keeps going with $\sum F = 0$.

Newton's 1st law

Equilibrium: condition and the two possibilities

Newton's 2nd law: equation and meaning

Newton's 3rd law, and why the pair does not cancel

RECALL

SECTION SUMMARY

Close your notes before you write.

Use the checklist to find what still needs practice.

State Newton's three laws in your own words, and write the equation for weight.

- [ ] I can tell mass (kg) from weight (N) and find weight with $F_g = mg$.
- [ ] I can state all three laws and explain equilibrium.

Free-Body Diagrams

LEARNING TARGET I can draw a free-body diagram and find the net force on an object, including forces at an angle.

FREE-BODY DIAGRAMS · NORMAL FORCE

Slides 10–11

Common mix-up: FN does not always equal weight. That needs the level-surface conditions below.

Drawing an FBD: the rules

Common forces: Fg, FN, T

Normal force: direction, and when FN = Fg

BALANCED FORCES: BOOK AND LAMP

Slide 12

Two FBDs: book and lamp

Given: 2 kg book at rest on a table; 1.5 kg lamp at rest on a rope; $g = 9.8\ m/s^2$.

Find: the free-body diagram of each, and the upward force on each.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

NET FORCE IN ONE DIMENSION

Slide 13

Slide 14: worked on the board.

Given: crate; 30 N right; 10 N left. Positive: right. **Find:** $\sum F$, with its direction.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

Net force: the method

RESULTANT FORCE AND DIRECTION

Slide 15

Given: 40 N right (+x) and 30 N up, perpendicular. **Find:** the size and direction of the resultant.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

BREAKING A FORCE INTO COMPONENTS

Slide 16

Given: F = 100 N pulling 30° above the horizontal. **Find:** the horizontal and vertical components.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:
Components of an angled force

TWO ANGLED FORCES: TUGBOATS

Slide 18

Check the quadrant before reporting an angle

Slide 17: worked on the board.

Given: top view; 500 N at 30° above +x; 400 N at 45° above –x. Positive: +x right, +y up the page.
Find: the net force on the barge and its direction.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

RECALL

SECTION SUMMARY

Close your notes before you write.

Use the checklist to find what still needs practice.

Summarize how to find the net force from a free-body diagram, including a force at an angle.

- [ ] I can draw an FBD with one labeled arrow per force.
- [ ] I can add forces with signs and split an angled force into components.

Forces on an Incline

LEARNING TARGET I can split an object's weight into parts along and into a ramp and find the normal force.

GRAVITY ON A RAMP · NORMAL FORCE ON AN INCLINE

Slides 20–21

Common mix-up: on a ramp FN is mg cos θ, less than the weight.

Ramp axes and the weight components

FN on a ramp: equation, condition, steepness

INCLINE EXAMPLE: A 5 KG BLOCK

Slide 22

Given: m = 5 kg; frictionless 30° ramp; g = 9.8 m/s². **Find:** FBD, Fg,parallel, Fg,perp, and FN.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

INCLINE EXAMPLE: A PUSH UP THE RAMP

Slide 23

Given: m = 12 kg; frictionless 25° ramp; 30 N push uphill. Positive: downhill. **Find:** Fg,parallel and ∑F.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

RECALL

SECTION SUMMARY

Close your notes before you write.

Use the checklist to find what still needs practice.

Describe how to split the weight on a ramp, and how FN changes as the ramp gets steeper.

- [ ] I can write Fg,parallel = mg sin θ and Fg,perp = mg cos θ.
- [ ] I can find FN and the net force along a ramp.

Net Force and Acceleration

LEARNING TARGET I can use ∑F = ma to find acceleration, including on a ramp and in an elevator.

CALCULATING ACCELERATION

Slide 25

Given: m = 4 kg; ∑F = 12 N to the right. **Find:** the acceleration.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:
1 N in base units; direction of a

A CAR ACCELERATES

Slide 26

Slide 27: worked on the board.

Given: m = 1500 kg; 4500 N forward; 1200 N drag (backward). Positive: forward. **Find:** ∑F and a.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

A SLED PULLED AT AN ANGLE

Slide 28

FN here is less than mg

Given: m = 20 kg; 60 N pull at 35° above horizontal; ignore friction. Positive: +x (right) and up.
Find: the acceleration and the normal force.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

ACCELERATION DOWN A FRICTIONLESS RAMP

Slide 29

Given: m = 8 kg; frictionless 20° ramp. Positive: downhill. **Find:** the acceleration.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:
Frictionless ramp: acceleration

ELEVATORS AND APPARENT WEIGHT

Slide 30

In an elevator, FN equals mg only when a = 0.

Apparent weight: what a scale reads

Elevator equation (up positive) and the a = 0 case

Scale reading: what changes it

ELEVATOR ACCELERATING UP

Slide 31

Slide 32: worked on the board.

Given: m = 70 kg; a = 2.0 m/s² upward. Positive: up. **Find:** the scale reading.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

RECALL

SECTION SUMMARY

Close your notes before you write.

Use the checklist to find what still needs practice.

List the steps from a free-body diagram to an acceleration. Add how a scale reading changes in an accelerating elevator.

- [ ] I can find a from ∑F = ma, with units and direction.
- [ ] I can find a scale reading with FN – mg = ma.

Friction

LEARNING TARGET I can tell static from kinetic friction and find friction, net force and acceleration on level ground and on a ramp.

STATIC AND KINETIC FRICTION · COMPARING COEFFICIENTS

Slides 34–35

Table values are approximate (OpenStax)

Friction: definition

Static vs. kinetic friction: equations

μ: units, and what a higher value means

Extra notes:

FRICTION AT CONSTANT VELOCITY

Slide 36

Given: m = 40 kg; level floor; constant velocity; 120 N horizontal push. **Find:** FN, fk, and μk.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

STATIC OR SLIDING: THE 25 KG BOX

Slide 37

Given: m = 25 kg, starts at rest; μs = 0.40; μk = 0.30; pushes of 90 N and 110 N. Positive: the push direction.

Find: whether the box moves for each push, and the acceleration for 110 N.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

ANGLED PULL WITH FRICTION

Slide 38

Given: m = 30 kg, sliding; 150 N rope at 30° above horizontal; μk = 0.25. Positive: +x (horizontal, toward the pull) and up.

Find: FN, fk, and a.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

FRICTION ON AN INCLINE

Slide 39

Friction on a ramp: direction and equations

Condition to start sliding down

SLIDING DOWN THE RAMP: THE 10 KG BLOCK

Slide 40

Given: m = 10 kg, at rest; 35° ramp; μs = 0.50; μk = 0.40. Positive: downhill. **Find:** if it slides, and a.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

RECALL

SECTION SUMMARY

Close your notes before you write.

Use the checklist to find what still needs practice.

Explain how to decide whether an object at rest starts to slide, and how to find its acceleration once it does.

- [ ] I can tell static from kinetic friction and use $f_{s,max} = \mu_s F_N$.
- [ ] I can find friction and acceleration on level ground and on a ramp.

Connected Objects

LEARNING TARGET I can find tension and acceleration for objects joined by cables, ropes and pulleys.

STREETLIGHT CABLE TENSION

Slide 42

Given: 20 kg streetlight at rest; left cable 30° above horizontal; right cable 60°; ignore cable mass. Positive: right and up.

Find: the tension in each support cable.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:
Cable with more tension

IDEAL STRINGS AND PULLEYS

Slide 43

Ideal string and pulley

Fixed-pulley rules and the method

Extra notes:

ATWOOD MACHINE

Slide 44

Given: $m_1 = 5$ kg, $m_2 = 3$ kg, both hanging. Positive: the motion (5 kg down, 3 kg up). **Find:** a and T.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

A BLOCK ON A FRICTIONLESS TABLE

Slide 45

Hanging mass accelerates down; table block, toward the pulley

Given: m_1 = 4 kg on the table; m_2 = 2 kg hanging. Positive: the motion. **Find:** a and T.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

THE SAME SYSTEM WITH FRICTION

Slide 46

Given: m_1 = 4 kg on the table, μk = 0.20; m_2 = 2 kg hanging. Positive: the motion. **Find:** fk, a, and T.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

CHALLENGE: INCLINE AND PULLEY

Slide 47

Given: m_1 = 6 kg on a frictionless 30° ramp; m_2 = 5 kg hanging. Positive: the motion (5 kg down, 6 kg up the ramp).

Find: a and T.

WORK / show your reasoning and units

Answer:

RECALL

SECTION SUMMARY

Close your notes before you write.

Use the checklist to find what still needs practice.

Write the two-step method for objects joined by a rope over a pulley.

- [ ] I can solve a cable-tension problem with ∑Fx = 0 and ∑Fy = 0.
- [ ] I can find a and T for an Atwood machine and a table-and-pulley system.

Connect the ideas, check common mix-ups, and explain the physics in your own words.

S03.1 Newton's laws

Mass (kg) stays the same from place to place; weight, Fg = mg (N), depends on g. ∑F = 0: constant velocity.

Watch out: A moving object does not need a net force to keep moving.

S03.2 Free-body diagrams

One object, one labeled arrow per force. Add with signs; split an angled force into Fx = F cos θ and Fy = F sin θ.

Watch out: Third-law pairs act on two objects, so they never cancel on one FBD.

S03.3 Forces on an incline

Tilt the axes: Fg,parallel = mg sin θ, Fg,perp = mg cos θ. FN = mg cos θ (ramp, no other perpendicular force).

Watch out: Normal force does not always equal weight. A steeper ramp gives a smaller FN.

S03.4 Net force and acceleration

a = ∑F / m, in the direction of ∑F. Frictionless ramp: a = g sin θ. Elevator, up positive: FN – mg = ma.

Watch out: The scale reads FN, which changes with acceleration, not with moving up or down.

S03.5 Friction

Static friction matches the need, up to fs,max = μsFN. Sliding friction, fk ≈ μkFN, is usually smaller.

Watch out: Find FN first. An angled pull or a ramp changes it.

S03.6 Connected objects

Ideal rope: one tension T, one size of a. Find a from the whole system, then T from one object's ∑F = ma.

Watch out: Draw a separate FBD for each object.

QUICK RECALL / COVER THE EXPLANATIONS ABOVE

1. State the condition for equilibrium.
2. Write the weight components for a block on a ramp.
3. Explain why a scale reads more in an elevator accelerating up.